QUIC · HTTP/3

A cord versus a caller ID

Why TCP breaks when your network changes

THE PAIN

- TCP identifies a session by IP:port
- Wi-Fi hands over to LTE, the IP changes
- Connection dies, the stream stalls
- Handshake and download start over

WHAT QUIC DOES

- Holds a Connection ID, not an IP
- Network switches, the stream keeps flowing
- 1-RTT instead of 2, 0-RTT on resume
- A lost packet stalls one stream, not all

MEASURED

−18%

YouTube rebuffer rate at Google

Meta saw 20% fewer video stalls

HONESTLY

- Corporate firewalls still block UDP/443
- User-space CPU runs 10–15% above TCP
- Caddy turns HTTP/3 on by default
- nginx has it since 1.25, experimental

TAKEAWAY

Not «faster», but «does not fall apart when your network moves»

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